

SOME AFFORDABLE DRONES AVAILABLE

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The concept of drones/unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs) has been constantly developing with technology getting more advanced these days. Earlier, this technology was utilised only for military purposes but for the past few decades, drones have become easily available to businesses across all sectors and to regular people, too. Technologists have been continuously contributing to the development of drone technology, and drone manufacturers are finding ways to make it more cost-effective.

According to market research firm Statista, their sales are escalating in various parts of the world. In the US, the sales are speculated to cross the one billion dollar mark. According to a report by FICCI and Ernst & Young, the Indian drone market is speculated to reach around 885.7 million dollars by 2021 with the international UAV market size reaching close to 21.47 billion dollars.

Drone is now being used in various verticals such as logistics and transportation, security, photography and filmmaking, and entertainment sectors. Various industries are now seeing this technology as an opportunity to reduce their costs.

Hence, we will showcase some of the latest and affordable drones available in the market. But before that, let's find out the qualities and requirements

one should look for before buying this product.

Register and know where to fly. Your drone needs to be registered, irrespective of whether you are using it for photography, videography, or just for fun. Also, if your product weighs less than 25kg, or if you are using it for commercial purposes, you need to take additional steps for registration. And before flying a drone, you must know some additional guidelines—flying within 8km of any airport is prohibited, flying below 122 metres (400 feet) is allowed, and most importantly, flying a drone over any government building is not allowed.

Budget. The most important thing to consider before buying any product is budget. You should be ready to pay a high price on industrial drones that come with heavy-duty motors. After you know the purpose of buying a drone, you can easily set your budget by checking out the various price ranges for the drones. A slightly expensive drone is better because it is lighter and comes with a flying training mode.

Drone types. Before you buy any tech product, it is advisable to check all the brands and features as it would help in selecting the product as per your requirements. That's the same with drones. There are four types of drones that you must know and then set your buying target.

The first one is Ready to Fly (RTF), but it is a bit expensive. You just need to charge the batteries and attach the propellers. The second one is Bind to fly (BTF), which doesn't come with a controller and it needs to be installed on your mobile device. The third is Almost ready to fly (ARF), which is basically a drone kit and does not include transmitters and receivers.

Most of them do not have motors, speed controllers, flight controllers, or batteries. Thus, you will have to make your entire drone, while additional items need to be purchased. The last is First-person video (FPV) that can capture footage and send the footage to your smartphone, VR headsets, or other compatible devices.

Weather conditions. Always keep in mind the weather conditions of your region when you are flying a drone. If there is wind in your area, your drone must have the potential to handle it because many of them can handle only 20mph (nearly 32kmph) wind speeds. Also, ensure that your drone is waterproof because there is a lot of moisture in windy areas.

Now, let us find out the latest and affordable drones available in the market.

DJI Mavic Air 2. This product is equipped with a camera sensor of 12MP and has a flying range of 10km, while it is powered by a 395mAh battery



and weighs only 570gm. According to some reviewers, this is an

ideal option for beginners. It has the potential to shoot a top-notch 4K/60p video and is furnished with a vast number of shooting features and 34-minute constant flying time. It has a new 1.3cm (½-inch) sensor that assures enhanced ISO performance and supports slo-mo 1080p video up to 240fps.

Price: \$799

DJI Mavic 2 Pro. The Mavic 2 Pro has a state-of-the-art camera sensor of 20MP that weighs only 970gm. Along